

various reasons why you spend. Then we'll wrap up with how to stop overspending on the things you can't avoid entirely.

In part 3, we tell you how to avoid going broke, which is essentially practical tips to make all this sustainable so you can stick with it long enough to master the skill. We'll look at your zones of influence so you can set up your environments, internally and externally, for success.

In each part, our aim is to show our work. You won't leave a chapter without knowing how to take action, and why each action is recommended so you don't waste your time with things that will never work for you. Each chapter will end with a lightning-round question and an action step. On the podcast, we call the lightning round our vulnerability segment. At the end of each episode, we share a real-life peek into our lives and the radical middle we're finding between knowing what we're supposed to do and actually doing it. Each lightning-round question in this book will give you the opportunity to do the same. Get honest about your answers to these questions and you'll be a step closer to honing your values-based spending skills. The action step will give you one thing to do or show you how to take action based on what you just read. It's not a requirement to complete before you move on, but we invite you to start implementing these practices when you're ready. You will hear from both of us (Jen and Jill) throughout the book—we each wrote different chapters and sometimes we pop up in each other's chapters—but we will be sure to let you know who's talking.

Let's Go

No matter where you are, what you earn, or what you love, you can improve your spending. In fact, we believe your biggest barrier to learning values-based spending will not be your capacity for learning a new skill, it will be your hesitance to unlearn the ideas that you don't need to spend money to become who you want to be. You don't need to buy people things to be loving, you don't need to buy your kids stuff to be a good parent, you don't need to buy items to support causes, and you don't need to buy new clothes to be accepted or taken seriously. You can spend money to have fun, but you don't need to.

We're so excited to be with you on this journey. And it is a lifelong journey. Mastery of a skill is not a destination. We're going to do everything